Scale Exercises - Section IV, Level 34

One key. Five frames. Four seams.

A Major Pentatonic Five-Position Connection

Hold A major pentatonic constant while the fretting hand moves through five common positions.

1. Fix the sound

A B C# E F#. The key does not transpose in this level. Every frame contains the same five pitch classes and must continue to sound like A major pentatonic.

2. Learn five positions

P1 begins at the low-E root frame. P2, P3, P4, and P5 continue upward through the octave. Position labels use ascending-neck order in this workbook.

3. Connect the seams

Adjacent positions share one anchor note on every string. Shift around that common note, then link all five frames in a forward and reverse zigzag.

Worked overview - one fixed key across five frames

A major pentatonic: A B C# E F# | Scale degrees: 1 2 3 5 6

```
P1  frets 4-7   starts on degree 1   roots E5, D7, e5
P2  frets 6-10  starts on degree 2   roots D7, B10
P3  frets 9-12  starts on degree 3   roots A12, B10
P4  frets 11-14 starts on degree 5   roots A12, G14
P5  frets 14-17 starts on degree 6   roots E17, G14, e17

POSITION CYCLE   P1(1) -> P2(2) -> P3(3) -> P4(5) -> P5(6)
CORE COUNTS      5 position cells = 120 notes | 4 seam cells = 120 notes
                  forward + reverse zigzag = 120 notes | complete workout = 360 notes
```

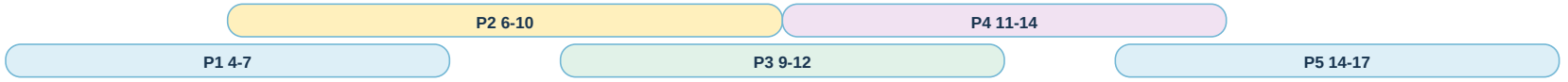
IMPORTANT Other methods number pentatonic boxes differently. Use the fret spans and degree maps, not the label alone.

Session protocol

1. Say A B C# E F#.
2. Learn P1 and its roots.
3. Add one frame at a time.
4. Play every cell D-start and U-start.
5. Learn the four shared-anchor seams.
6. Play the forward zigzag.
7. Link forward and reverse without a

Level 34 - Fixed-Key A Major-Pentatonic Atlas

Roots are highlighted. Colored position spans overlap because adjacent frames share one note on every string.



Fret	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
e		R/A		2/B		3/C#			5/E		6/F#			R/A
B		5/E		6/F#			R/A		2/B		3/C#			5/E
G	2/B		3/C#			5/E		6/F#			R/A		2/B	
D	6/F#			R/A		2/B		3/C#			5/E		6/F#	
A	3/C#			5/E		6/F#			R/A		2/B		3/C#	
E		R/A		2/B		3/C#			5/E		6/F#			R/A

Pos	Span	Low-E start	Roots inside frame	Ascending degree order
P1	4-7	1	E5, D7, e5	1 2 3 5 6 1 2 3 5 6 1 2
P2	6-10	2	D7, B10	2 3 5 6 1 2 3 5 6 1 2 3
P3	9-12	3	A12, B10	3 5 6 1 2 3 5 6 1 2 3 5
P4	11-14	5	A12, G14	5 6 1 2 3 5 6 1 2 3 5 6
P5	14-17	6	E17, G14, e17	6 1 2 3 5 6 1 2 3 5 6 1

Seam	Shared anchors: E A D G B e
P1-P2	7 7 7 6 7 7
P2-P3	9 9 9 9 10 9
P3-P4	12 12 11 11 12 12
P4-P5	14 14 14 14 14 14

At every seam, shift after the shared note - not before it. Roots remain A even when a frame begins on degree 2, 3, 5, or 6.

Level 34 - Position 1: Root Frame

frets 4-7. Starts on scale degree 1. Roots: E5, D7, e5.

Position 1 vertical cell - 12 notes up + 12 notes down

The highest note is articulated once at the end of the ascent and again to begin the descent.

```
Nte|A--B--C#-E--F#-A--B--C#-E--F#-A--B--|B--A--F#-E--C#-B--A--F#-E--C#-B--A--|
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--|2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--1--3--2--4--2--4--|4--2--4--2--3--1--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------5--7--|7--5-----------------------------|
B  |-----------------------5--7--------|------7--5-----------------------|
G  |-----------------4--6--------------|------------6--4-----------------|
D  |------------4--7--------------------|--------------------7--4--------------|
A  |------4--7--------------------------|--------------------------7--4--------|
E  |5--7--------------------------------|--------------------------------7--5--|
```

PICKING 24 notes is even. Every new cell begins with the original D-start or U-start orientation.

Position DNA

E:	5-7	f2-4	d1-2
A:	4-7	f1-4	d3-5
D:	4-7	f1-4	d6-1
G:	4-6	f1-3	d2-3
B:	5-7	f2-4	d5-6
e:	5-7	f2-4	d1-2

Roots

E5, D7, e5

Hand note

Low-E root at fret 5. This is the reference frame for the section.

Pass 1 - map the frame

Play eighth notes. Say every degree aloud. Stop after the cell, relax the hand, and verify every A root before repeating.

Pass 2 - root targeting

Accent only degree 1, then remove the accent. On a second pass, sustain each root slightly while keeping the underlying pulse unchanged.

Pass 3 - prepare the seam

Begin descending first, repeat with both pick starts, then practice the shared-anchor seam into the next position.

Level 34 - Position 2: Second-Degree Frame

frets 6-10. Starts on scale degree 2. Roots: D7, B10.

Position 2 vertical cell - 12 notes up + 12 notes down

The highest note is articulated once at the end of the ascent and again to begin the descent.

```
Nte|B--C#-E--F#-A--B--C#-E--F#-A--B--C#-|C#-B--A--F#-E--C#-B--A--F#-E--C#-B--|
Deg|2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--|3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--|
Fng|1--3--1--3--1--3--1--4--1--4--1--3--|3--1--4--1--4--1--3--1--3--1--3--1--|
e  |-----------------------------7--9--|9--7-----------------------------|
B  |------------------------7--10-------|------10-7-------------------------|
G  |------------------6--9--------------|------------9--6--------------------|
D  |------------7--9--------------------|--------------------9--7--------------|
A  |------7--9---------------------------|-----------------------9--7--------|
E  |7--9--------------------------------|-----------------------------9--7--|
```

PICKING 24 notes is even. Every new cell begins with the original D-start or U-start orientation.

Position DNA

```
E:  7-9   f1-3  d2-3
A:  7-9   f1-3  d5-6
D:  7-9   f1-3  d1-2
G:  6-9   f1-4  d3-5
B:  7-10  f1-4  d6-1
e:  7-9   f1-3  d2-3
```

Roots

D7, B10

Hand note

Re-form the hand around frets 7-10; reach back for G-string fret 6. Do not hold a rigid five-fret stretch.

Pass 1 - map the frame

Play eighth notes. Say every degree aloud. Stop after the cell, relax the hand, and verify every A root before repeating.

Pass 2 - root targeting

Accent only degree 1, then remove the accent. On a second pass, sustain each root slightly while keeping the underlying pulse unchanged.

Pass 3 - prepare the seam

Begin descending first, repeat with both pick starts, then practice the shared-anchor seam into the next position.

Level 34 - Position 3: Third-Degree Frame

frets 9-12. Starts on scale degree 3. Roots: A12, B10.

Position 3 vertical cell - 12 notes up + 12 notes down

The highest note is articulated once at the end of the ascent and again to begin the descent.

```
Nte|C#-E--F#-A--B--C#-E--F#-A--B--C#-E--|E--C#-B--A--F#-E--C#-B--A--F#-E--C#-|
Deg|3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--|5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--|
Fng|1--4--1--4--1--3--1--3--2--4--1--4--|4--1--4--2--3--1--3--1--4--1--4--1--|
e  |-----------------------------9--12-|12-9-----------------------------|
B  |------------------------10-12-------|------12-10------------------------|
G  |------------------9--11-------------|------------11-9--------------------|
D  |------------9--11-------------------|-------------------11-9-------------|
A  |------9--12-------------------------|-------------------------12-9--------|
E  |9--12-------------------------------|-------------------------------12-9--|
```

PICKING 24 notes is even. Every new cell begins with the original D-start or U-start orientation.

Position DNA

```
E:  9-12  f1-4  d3-5
A:  9-12  f1-4  d6-1
D:  9-11  f1-3  d2-3
G:  9-11  f1-3  d5-6
B: 10-12  f2-4  d1-2
e:  9-12  f1-4  d3-5
```

Roots

A12, B10

Hand note

The low-string minor-third spans alternate with compact whole-step pairs on D, G, and B.

Pass 1 - map the frame

Play eighth notes. Say every degree aloud. Stop after the cell, relax the hand, and verify every A root before repeating.

Pass 2 - root targeting

Accent only degree 1, then remove the accent. On a second pass, sustain each root slightly while keeping the underlying pulse unchanged.

Pass 3 - prepare the seam

Begin descending first, repeat with both pick starts, then practice the shared-anchor seam into the next position.

Level 34 - Position 4: Fifth-Degree Frame

frets 11-14. Starts on scale degree 5. Roots: A12, G14.

Position 4 vertical cell - 12 notes up + 12 notes down

The highest note is articulated once at the end of the ascent and again to begin the descent.

```
Nte|E--F#-A--B--C#-E--F#-A--B--C#-E--F#-|F#-E--C#-B--A--F#-E--C#-B--A--F#-E--|
Deg|5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--|6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--|
Fng|2--4--2--4--1--4--1--4--2--4--2--4--|4--2--4--2--4--1--4--1--4--2--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------12-14-|14-12-----------------------------|
B  |------------------------12-14-------|------14-12------------------------|
G  |------------------11-14-------------|------------14-11------------------|
D  |------------11-14-------------------|-------------------14-11-----------|
A  |------12-14-------------------------|-------------------------14-12-------|
E  |12-14-------------------------------|-------------------------------14-12-|
```

PICKING 24 notes is even. Every new cell begins with the original D-start or U-start orientation.

Position DNA

```
E: 12-14  f2-4  d5-6
A: 12-14  f2-4  d1-2
D: 11-14  f1-4  d3-5
G: 11-14  f1-4  d6-1
B: 12-14  f2-4  d2-3
e: 12-14  f2-4  d5-6
```

Roots

A12, G14

Hand note

Roots sit on A-string fret 12 and G-string fret 14. Let those notes re-center the key.

Pass 1 - map the frame

Play eighth notes. Say every degree aloud. Stop after the cell, relax the hand, and verify every A root before repeating.

Pass 2 - root targeting

Accent only degree 1, then remove the accent. On a second pass, sustain each root slightly while keeping the underlying pulse unchanged.

Pass 3 - prepare the seam

Begin descending first, repeat with both pick starts, then practice the shared-anchor seam into the next position.

Level 34 - Position 5: Sixth-Degree Frame

frets 14-17. Starts on scale degree 6. Roots: E17, G14, e17.

Position 5 vertical cell - 12 notes up + 12 notes down

The highest note is articulated once at the end of the ascent and again to begin the descent.

```
Nte|F#-A--B--C#-E--F#-A--B--C#-E--F#-A--|A--F#-E--C#-B--A--F#-E--C#-B--A--F#-|
Deg|6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--|1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--|
Fng|1--4--1--3--1--3--1--3--1--4--1--4--|4--1--4--1--3--1--3--1--3--1--4--1--|
e  |-----------------------------14-17-|17-14-----------------------------|
B  |-------------------------14-17-------|------17-14-------------------------|
G  |-------------------14-16-------------|------------16-14-------------------|
D  |------------14-16--------------------|--------------------16-14------------|
A  |------14-16-------------------------|-------------------------16-14-------|
E  |14-17-------------------------------|-------------------------------17-14-|
```

PICKING 24 notes is even. Every new cell begins with the original D-start or U-start orientation.

Position DNA

```
E: 14-17  f1-4  d6-1
A: 14-16  f1-3  d2-3
D: 14-16  f1-3  d5-6
G: 14-16  f1-3  d1-2
B: 14-17  f1-4  d3-5
e: 14-17  f1-4  d6-1
```

Roots

E17, G14, e17

Hand note

This frame closes the octave at low- and high-e fret 17 and prepares the return route.

Pass 1 - map the frame

Play eighth notes. Say every degree aloud. Stop after the cell, relax the hand, and verify every A root before repeating.

Pass 2 - root targeting

Accent only degree 1, then remove the accent. On a second pass, sustain each root slightly while keeping the underlying pulse unchanged.

Pass 3 - prepare the seam

Begin descending first, repeat with both pick starts, then prepare the reverse zigzag back through Position 4.

Level 34 - Shared-Anchor Seams I

Each five-note loop moves out of the lower frame, crosses the shared anchor, enters the upper frame, and returns.

Seam P1 <-> P2: shared-anchor five-note loops

Anchors: E7, A7, D7, G6, B7, e7. Shift upward after note 2; shift back after note 4.

```
Deg|1--2--3--2--1--|3--5--6--5--3--|6--1--2--1--6--|2--3--5--3--2--|5--6--1--6--5--|1--2--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--3--1--2--|1--4--3--1--1--|1--4--3--1--1--|1--3--4--1--1--|2--4--4--1--2--|2--4--3--1--2--|
e  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|5--7--9--7--5--|
B  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|5--7--10-7--5--|---------------|
G  |---------------|---------------|---------------|4--6--9--6--4--|---------------|---------------|
D  |---------------|---------------|4--7--9--7--4--|---------------|---------------|---------------|
A  |---------------|4--7--9--7--4--|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
E  |5--7--9--7--5--|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
```

COUNT 6 strings x 5 notes = 30 notes. Odd groups flip the starting stroke; the complete seam cell is even.

Seam P2 <-> P3: shared-anchor five-note loops

Anchors: E9, A9, D9, G9, B10, e9. Shift upward after note 2; shift back after note 4.

```
Deg|2--3--5--3--2--|5--6--1--6--5--|1--2--3--2--1--|3--5--6--5--3--|6--1--2--1--6--|2--3--5--3--2--|
Fng|1--3--4--1--1--|1--3--4--1--1--|1--3--3--1--1--|1--4--3--1--1--|1--4--4--2--1--|1--3--4--1--1--|
e  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|7--9--12-9--7--|
B  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|7--10-12-10-7--|---------------|
G  |---------------|---------------|---------------|6--9--11-9--6--|---------------|---------------|
D  |---------------|---------------|7--9--11-9--7--|---------------|---------------|---------------|
A  |---------------|7--9--12-9--7--|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
E  |7--9--12-9--7--|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
```

COUNT 6 strings x 5 notes = 30 notes. Odd groups flip the starting stroke; the complete seam cell is even.

Level 34 - Shared-Anchor Seams II

Each five-note loop moves out of the lower frame, crosses the shared anchor, enters the upper frame, and returns.

Seam P3 <-> P4: shared-anchor five-note loops

Anchors: E12, A12, D11, G11, B12, e12. Shift upward after note 2; shift back after note 4.

```
Deg|3--5--6--5--3--|6--1--2--1--6--|2--3--5--3--2--|5--6--1--6--5--|1--2--3--2--1--|3--5--6--5--3--|
Fng|1--4--4--2--1--|1--4--4--2--1--|1--3--4--1--1--|1--3--4--1--1--|2--4--4--2--2--|1--4--4--2--1--|
e  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|9--12-14-12-9--|
B  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|10-12-14-12-10-|---------------|
G  |---------------|---------------|---------------|9--11-14-11-9--|---------------|---------------|
D  |---------------|---------------|9--11-14-11-9--|---------------|---------------|---------------|
A  |---------------|9--12-14-12-9--|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
E  |9--12-14-12-9--|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
```

COUNT 6 strings x 5 notes = 30 notes. Odd groups flip the starting stroke; the complete seam cell is even.

Seam P4 <-> P5: shared-anchor five-note loops

Anchors: E14, A14, D14, G14, B14, e14. Shift upward after note 2; shift back after note 4.

```
Deg|5--6--1--6--5--|1--2--3--2--1--|3--5--6--5--3--|6--1--2--1--6--|2--3--5--3--2--|5--6--1--6--5--|
Fng|2--4--4--1--2--|2--4--3--1--2--|1--4--3--1--1--|1--4--3--1--1--|2--4--4--1--2--|2--4--4--1--2--|
e  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|12-14-17-14-12-|
B  |---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|12-14-17-14-12-|---------------|
G  |---------------|---------------|---------------|11-14-16-14-11-|---------------|---------------|
D  |---------------|---------------|11-14-16-14-11-|---------------|---------------|---------------|
A  |---------------|12-14-16-14-12-|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
E  |12-14-17-14-12-|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
```

COUNT 6 strings x 5 notes = 30 notes. Odd groups flip the starting stroke; the complete seam cell is even.

Level 34 - Forward Five-Position Zigzag

Climb the neck while alternating vertical direction. Every seam advances by one pentatonic scale step.

P1 ASC e7->e9 P2 DESC E7->E9 P3 ASC e12->e14 P4 DESC E12->E14 P5 ASC

P1 ASC - frets 4-7

Start degree 1; end degree 2; 12 notes.

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--1--3--2--4--2--4--|
e  |-------------------------------5--7--|
B  |----------------------5--7--------|
G  |------------------4--6-------------|
D  |------------4--7--------------------|
A  |------4--7---------------------------|
E  |5--7-----------------------------|
```

P2 DESC - frets 6-10

Start degree 3; end degree 2; 12 notes.

```
Deg|3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--|
Fng|3--1--4--1--4--1--3--1--3--1--3--1--|
e  |9--7-------------------------------|
B  |------10-7--------------------------|
G  |------------9--6--------------------|
D  |------------------9--7-------------|
A  |----------------------9--7--------|
E  |-----------------------------9--7--|
```

P3 ASC - frets 9-12

Start degree 3; end degree 5; 12 notes.

```
Deg|3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--|
Fng|1--4--1--4--1--3--1--3--2--4--1--4--|
e  |-------------------------------9--12-|
B  |----------------------10-12-------|
G  |------------------9--11-------------|
D  |------------9--11--------------------|
A  |------9--12---------------------------|
E  |9--12-----------------------------|
```

P4 DESC - frets 11-14

Start degree 6; end degree 5; 12 notes.

```
Deg|6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--|
Fng|4--2--4--2--4--1--4--1--4--2--4--2--|
e  |14-12--------------------------------|
B  |------14-12-------------------------|
G  |------------14-11-------------------|
D  |------------------14-11-------------|
A  |----------------------14-12-------|
E  |-------------------------------14-12-|
```

P5 ASC - frets 14-17

Start degree 6; end degree 1; 12 notes.

```
Deg|6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--|
Fng|1--4--1--3--1--3--1--3--1--4--1--4--|
e  |-------------------------------14-17-|
B  |----------------------14-17-------|
G  |------------------14-16-------------|
D  |------------14-16--------------------|
A  |------14-16---------------------------|
E  |14-17-----------------------------|
```

RULE 5 positions x 12 notes = 60 notes. Each segment is even, so every new frame begins with the same pick orientation. Do not pause at a seam.

Level 34 - Reverse Five-Position Zigzag

Descend the neck through the same frames in reverse. Every seam falls by one pentatonic scale step.

P5 DESC E14->E12 P4 ASC e14->e12 P3 DESC E9->E7 P2 ASC e9->e7 P1 DESC

P5 DESC - frets 14-17

Start degree 1; end degree 6; 12 notes.

```
Deg|1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--|
Fng|4--1--4--1--3--1--3--1--3--1--4--1--|
e  |17-14-------------------------------|
B  |------17-14-----------------------|
G  |------------16-14-----------------|
D  |------------------16-14-----------|
A  |------------------------16-14-----|
E  |-------------------------------17-14-|
```

P4 ASC - frets 11-14

Start degree 5; end degree 6; 12 notes.

```
Deg|5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--|
Fng|2--4--2--4--1--4--1--4--2--4--2--4--|
e  |-------------------------------12-14-|
B  |-----------------------12-14-------|
G  |------------------11-14------------|
D  |------------11-14-----------------|
A  |------12-14-------------------------|
E  |12-14-------------------------------|
```

P3 DESC - frets 9-12

Start degree 5; end degree 3; 12 notes.

```
Deg|5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--|
Fng|4--1--4--2--3--1--3--1--4--1--4--1--|
e  |12-9--------------------------------|
B  |------12-10-----------------------|
G  |------------11-9------------------|
D  |------------------11-9------------|
A  |------------------------12-9-------|
E  |-------------------------------12-9--|
```

P2 ASC - frets 6-10

Start degree 2; end degree 3; 12 notes.

```
Deg|2--3--5--6--1--2--3--5--6--1--2--3--|
Fng|1--3--1--3--1--3--1--4--1--4--1--3--|
e  |-------------------------------7--9--|
B  |-----------------------7--10-------|
G  |------------------6--9-------------|
D  |------------7--9------------------|
A  |------7--9--------------------------|
E  |7--9--------------------------------|
```

P1 DESC - frets 4-7

Start degree 2; end degree 1; 12 notes.

```
Deg|2--1--6--5--3--2--1--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|4--2--4--2--3--1--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |7--5--------------------------------|
B  |------7--5--------------------------|
G  |------------6--4--------------------|
D  |------------------7--4-------------|
A  |-----------------------7--4--------|
E  |-------------------------------7--5--|
```

RULE 60 notes. Link after the forward route by repeating high-e fret 17 as the reverse starting note; the combined circuit is 120 notes and returns to low-E fret 5.

Level 34 - Practice Progression, Mastery Gate, and Log

Advance by adding position connections before adding speed. The fixed key must remain audible throughout the route.

Seven-phase progression

1. Map P1-P5 and say each starting degree.
2. Play every 24-note vertical cell with both pick starts.
3. Learn all four 30-note shared-anchor seam cells.
4. Play the 60-note forward zigzag without a seam pause.
5. Play the 60-note reverse zigzag without a seam pause.
6. Link forward + reverse as one 120-note circuit.
7. Accent roots, then remove all root accents while hearing A as tonic.

Counts and repair rules

5 position cells	120 notes
4 seam cells	120 notes
Forward + reverse zigzag	120 notes
Complete Level 34 workout	360 notes / 90 sixteenth-note beats

LOST KEY CENTER	Stop on the nearest A; sing it; restart the local frame.
WRONG BOX	Name the fret span and first low-E degree.
EARLY SHIFT	Stay in the lower frame through the anchor; move after it sounds.
NOISY SEAM	Release pressure, move the thumb, and reduce 4-6 BPM.
PICK RESET	Air-pick the exact 12-, 30-, or 60-note count.

Mastery gate before Level 35

Name all five positions and their fret spans; play each vertical cell cleanly with D-start and U-start; shift at every shared anchor without a scrape or hesitation; complete the linked 120-note zigzag on two separate days; identify every A root by sight and sound; and recover the correct position after a deliberate stop.

ADVANCEMENT Add 2 BPM after three clean circuits. After two errors, reduce 4-6 BPM or shorten the route to one seam.

Practice log

Date	Focus	D/U	BPM	Clean?	Weak seam / position	Next target

NEXT Level 35 isolates horizontal A-major-pentatonic motion along individual strings and turns the five position seams into melodic shifts.